

How to Use or Adapt Convalescent Snakes & Ladders

This guide explains how to view, copy, or adapt the Convalescent Snakes & Ladders project using GitHub. No programming experience is required.

1. What You Need Before You Start

- A web browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, etc.)
- A free GitHub account

(create one at <https://github.com> — this takes about 2 minutes)

You do not need to install software or understand coding.

2. Viewing the Project (No Account Needed)

You can view and interact with the project here:

<https://github.com/AppleVioletRobot/snakey>

This version is read-only and suitable for demonstration or teaching.

3. Making Your Own Copy (Forking the Project)

If you want to adapt, edit, or experiment with the project, you need your own copy.

Step-by-step:

1. Go to the project page on GitHub
(e.g. <https://github.com/AppleVioletRobot/snakey>)
2. In the top-right corner, click Fork
3. Choose your own account when prompted

That's it — GitHub creates a personal copy of the entire project under your account.

You now have:

- Your own editable version
- No risk of affecting the original
- Full freedom to experiment

4. Making Changes (No Coding Required)

Once you've forked the project:

1. Click into your copy of the repository
2. Navigate to the data/ folder

3. Click on files such as:
 - text.json
 - help.json
 - jumps.json
4. Click the Pencil Icon / Edit button
5. Make changes directly in the browser
6. Click Commit changes at the bottom

Your version updates instantly.

5. Publishing Your Version

Your fork can be made public as a live website:

1. Go to Settings → Pages
2. Under “Source”, choose:
 - Branch: main
 - Folder: /root
3. Save

GitHub will give you a public link you can share.

6. Attribution

If you adapt or reuse this project, please include the following somewhere visible (e.g. README, help screen):

© Alice van Rooyen, 2026.
Originally developed as Convalescent Snakes & Ladders.
Used under CC BY 4.0.

This protects academic attribution and helps others trace the work.

7. What You Don’t Need to Worry About

- You cannot “break” the original project if you are working on your forked copy
- You don’t need to understand the code to use it
- You don’t need permission to experiment
- You don’t need to publish anything publicly unless you choose to

8. If you need help

You can reach out to the original author at alice@applevioletrobot.com.